

# Abiodun M. Musbaudeen

---

Department of Economics  
Binghamton University (SUNY)

Phone: (607) 760-7889  
E-mail: amusbau1@binghamton.edu  
abiodunmusbaudeen.github.io

---

## Teaching Statement

My goal as a teacher is to help students gain the confidence and judgment to work through unfamiliar problems. I believe this requires clear explanations, regular practice, and opportunities to ask questions before a difficulty becomes a barrier to further learning. At Binghamton University, I taught **Statistical Methods in Summer 2025**. Since Fall 2022, my teaching assistantships have included Introduction to Microeconomics, Principles of Microeconomics, Introduction to Macroeconomics, Intermediate Microeconomics, Corporate Economics, Introduction to Econometrics, and Advanced Data Analytics. In Introduction to Econometrics in Fall 2025 and Fall 2026, I teach econometric concepts and lead R instruction.

I am prepared to teach principles of microeconomics and macroeconomics, intermediate microeconomics, managerial economics, statistics, and introductory econometrics, as well as electives in applied econometrics, causal inference, panel data, and data analytics. Across these courses, I place students' ability to use and explain what they learn at the center of my teaching.

## Making Learning a Continuing Process

I organize my teaching around the work students do between explanations. Following a solution during a lecture is only one step toward being able to solve a problem independently. I assigned weekly homework to give students regular opportunities to attempt the material, and I provided additional practice questions to support preparation for assessments. My purpose was to encourage sustained engagement and give students time to identify a difficulty, return to an explanation, and try again before an examination.

To support that process, I created online lecture videos on course topics and difficult concepts and uploaded my slides and lecture notes. I did this because a single explanation at a fixed pace cannot meet every student's needs. With a recording, students can pause at a difficult step and revisit it alongside the notes while working on a question. Making these resources available gives students more control over the pace of their learning. I see the homework and supporting materials as connected: practice gives students a reason to revisit an explanation, and the explanation supports their next attempt.

I also created an online collaboration platform where students could discuss difficult concepts with classmates before bringing unresolved questions to me. The purpose was to make explaining an idea part of learning it. Putting a question into words and considering another student's approach offer ways to examine one's own understanding. I complemented this space with flexible office hours and encouraged students to contact me when questions arose. Together, these practices made room for both peer discussion and individual support.

### **Using Explanations to Examine Understanding**

I want students to understand why a method applies and what an answer means. In my microeconomics teaching, I begin with an economic question before developing the formal argument. When discussing a tax, for example, I ask students to predict its effects, work through the graph, and explain the result in words. The purpose of moving between a prediction, a diagram, and a verbal explanation is to make the reasoning visible. It gives students several ways to approach the problem and gives me a basis for assessing what they understand beyond the final answer.

In econometrics, I use R simulations to connect assumptions with their consequences. Comparing an estimate with the known parameter used to generate the data, including when a relevant variable is omitted, provides a concrete basis for discussing why a result can be misleading. I use this connection between computation and interpretation to help students ask what supports a conclusion. The lesson I emphasize is that obtaining an estimate is part of an analysis; explaining its meaning and limitations is also necessary.

These activities reflect the standard guiding my assessment: students should be able to explain their choices and interpret their answers. A correct calculation alone gives an incomplete picture of understanding. A student's explanation helps distinguish difficulty selecting a method from difficulty carrying out the calculation or interpreting the result. That distinction matters for teaching because repeating a procedure may not address a misunderstanding about why it is appropriate. I regard questions and explanations as evidence to attend to throughout a course, alongside homework and examinations.

### **Building Confidence and Purpose**

I see access to help as part of effective instruction. Students bring different levels of preparation and confidence to economics and quantitative courses. My flexible office hours, recorded explanations, and online discussion space provided several ways to engage with a difficult idea. The principle behind these choices is that students should have a practical next step when they become stuck. I want asking a question to be an ordinary part of learning, and I value a precise account of a difficulty as a useful starting point for further work.

My experience in banking, e-commerce, and media analytics also informs why I emphasize clear interpretation and communication. In econometrics, students work with reproducible R scripts that connect data preparation, estimation, and interpretation. I emphasize documentation because an analysis needs to be understandable to someone who did not produce it. These habits help students prepare for further study and for work in which colleagues rely on their analysis to make decisions.

The purpose of my teaching is to help students become more capable learners: willing to attempt a difficult question, able to explain their reasoning, and ready to seek help or further evidence when needed. I support that development through regular practice, accessible explanations, and opportunities to work through questions with others.